ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

FAA 101: Foundations of Fine and Applied Arts - Drawing, Colour and Form

The studio habits that carry every later course

FACULTY PRIMER

Faculty Primer

Faculty of Arts
Fine & Applied Arts | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

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Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

This pack covers observational drawing, proportion and perspective, value and colour theory, composition, and the material differences between drawing, painting, sculpture and design media. It includes a weekly sketchbook routine that builds skill faster than occasional intense sessions.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Draw from observation with correct proportion and simple perspective.
- Use value to describe form and light.
- Apply colour theory in a composition.
- Keep a sketchbook that documents sustained practice.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Observation before expression

Draw what is there before you draw what you feel.

- Sight and measure: use your pencil to compare angles and proportions.
- Block in the largest shapes before detail.
- Check negative space to correct proportion errors.
- One- and two-point perspective for interiors and streets.
- Draw from life daily; photographs flatten form misleadingly.
- Date every page so progress is visible.

Value, light and colour

Value does most of the work of describing form.

- Build a nine-step value scale and use it to check drawings.
- Identify the light source and keep it consistent.
- Look for core shadow, reflected light and cast shadow.
- Colour theory: hue, value, saturation; complementary and analogous schemes.
- Local colour versus perceived colour under light.
- Test colour relationships rather than trusting memory.

> **Squint at it**
> Squinting collapses detail and reveals whether your values hold together. If the drawing collapses, fix the value structure, not the outline.

Media and studio practice

Materials have different affordances; learn them deliberately.

- Graphite: control, shading and erasure.
- Charcoal and conte: bold mass and expressive mark-making.
- Watercolour: transparency, layering and unforgiving corrections.
- Acrylic and oil: opacity, blending and drying differences.
- Clay and relief: form, armature and structural limits.
- Clean up, store work flat and label materials properly.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Why check negative space when drawing?

Answer: Because judging the shapes around an object exposes proportion errors the eye misses when focused on the object.

2. What are the three properties of colour?

Answer: Hue, value and saturation.

3. Name the parts of a cast shadow.

Answer: Core shadow, reflected light and cast shadow; highlight and midtone complete the light structure.

4. Why is daily sketching more effective than occasional long sessions?

Answer: Skill builds through frequent repetition and immediate correction, which short sessions support.

5. What is the difference between local and perceived colour?

Answer: Local colour is the object's inherent colour; perceived colour is how it appears under specific light and surroundings.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Fill ten sketchbook pages from observation.
- [ ] Build a nine-step value scale.
- [ ] Draw one interior in one-point perspective.
- [ ] Paint a simple colour wheel and two schemes.
- [ ] Make a value study of a still life.
- [ ] Experiment with two unfamiliar media.
- [ ] Review your first and last page side by side.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

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